Standard software and access for new employees

Article KB0010015 | Owner: Identity & Access Management | Subcategory: New joiner setup | Applies to: Windows 11 23H2/24H2 laptops (Dell Latitude, Lenovo ThinkPad, HP EliteBook), macOS 14/15 MacBook Pro/Air, Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) + on-premises Active Directory, Microsoft 365 (Outlook, Teams, OneDrive, SharePoint), Intune-managed Company Portal, Palo Alto GlobalProtect VPN, ACME-Corp Wi-Fi (802.1X)

Summary

This article describes the end-to-end process for provisioning a new Acme Global employee's identity, device, and core productivity services. It outlines what the joiner can do themselves, the steps the L1 Service Desk follows, how to verify successful onboarding, and when to escalate to the Identity & Access Management (IAM) team.

Symptoms

- Cannot sign in to Windows/macOS - error "The user name or password is incorrect"
- No mailbox visible in Outlook - message "Mailbox not found"
- Teams shows "You don't have access to any teams"
- Company Portal does not list required apps or shows "Device not compliant"
- VPN connection fails with "Certificate not trusted" or "Authentication failed"
- Wi-Fi prompts for credentials but rejects ACME-Corp network

Common causes

- HR has not submitted the official start date, so the account remains disabled
- AD account or mailbox was never created during the onboarding workflow
- Required Microsoft 365 licenses (E5/E3) were not assigned
- Intune device enrollment failed or the device is not marked compliant
- MFA enrollment was skipped, blocking conditional-access policies
- VPN or Wi-Fi machine certificate missing or expired

Prerequisites and Ownership

Before any work begins, confirm that the new joiner's personal data (legal name, employee ID, start date, manager, and department) has been entered into the HR system and that the HR-to-IT feed has run. The Identity & Access Management (IAM) team owns the creation of the Entra ID/AD user object, mailbox, and initial license assignment. The Service Desk L1 owns device delivery, Intune enrollment, and post-creation verification. All actions should be completed within the first business day of the employee's start date.

Self-Help Procedure for New Employees

If you receive your welcome email and have been told your laptop is ready, follow these steps to get logged in, secure your account, and install the core apps you need for day-one work.

1. 1. Open the welcome email from IT (subject: "Your Acme Global account is ready") and note your temporary password.
2. Go to https://passwordreset.acme.example, enter your employee ID (username@acme.example) and the temporary password, then choose a new password that meets the 14-character, 90-day expiry rule.
3. At the sign-in screen for Windows or macOS, enter your username and the new password. If prompted, approve the Microsoft Authenticator push notification (or enter the SMS code) to complete MFA registration.
4. Once at the desktop, open the Company Portal app (pre-installed on managed devices). Sign in with your Acme credentials.
5. In Company Portal, select "Required apps" and install Microsoft Outlook, Teams, OneDrive, and any role-specific applications listed.
6. After installation, restart the laptop if prompted, then verify you can send/receive email in Outlook and join a test meeting in Teams.
7. Connect to the ACME-Corp Wi-Fi using your laptop's machine certificate (no username/password required). If you need remote access, launch GlobalProtect; the certificate-based login should succeed automatically.

Service Desk Procedure (L1)

When a ticket arrives indicating a new joiner cannot log in or lacks expected resources, follow this checklist to remediate the issue and close the ticket.

1. 1. Verify the employee's start date in the HR system (Workday) and confirm the account status in Entra ID.
   - If the account is **Disabled** because the start date is in the future, note the ticket and inform the manager that the account will be enabled on the effective date.
   - If the account is **Enabled** but the user reports password failure, initiate a self-service password reset via https://passwordreset.acme.example or issue a Temporary Access Pass through IAM.
2. Check mailbox existence and license assignment:
   - In the Microsoft 365 admin center, locate the user and confirm an Exchange Online Plan 2 (or E3/E5) license is assigned.
   - If missing, assign the appropriate license and wait up to 15 minutes for propagation.
3. Confirm Intune device compliance:
   - In Intune, locate the device by serial number or user name. Ensure the status is **Compliant** and that the required apps (Company Portal, Outlook, Teams, OneDrive) are installed.
   - If non-compliant, retry enrollment or push the missing apps via a device action.
4. Validate MFA registration:
   - In Entra ID, under the user's authentication methods, verify that Microsoft Authenticator (push) is registered and a backup SMS method is present.
   - If missing, send a Temporary Access Pass and ask the user to complete MFA registration at https://aka.ms/mfasetup.
5. Test connectivity:
   - Log onto the device with the user's credentials and confirm Outlook can sync mail.
   - Join a Teams test call.
   - Attempt to connect to the ACME-Corp Wi-Fi (should authenticate silently).
   - Launch GlobalProtect and verify a successful VPN connection.
6. Document all actions in the ticket, add the final verification screenshots (Outlook inbox, Teams status, Intune compliance), set the ticket status to **Resolved**, and notify the employee's manager that onboarding is complete.

Common Issues and Troubleshooting Tips

Even with a standard process, certain scenarios recur. Knowing the symptoms and quick fixes reduces handling time.

1. - **Account still disabled after start date** - Double-check the HR feed; sometimes a contractor's start date is recorded incorrectly. Ask HR to correct the date and re-run the feed.
- **Password reset loop** - Ensure the user is not exceeding the 5-attempt lockout. After lockout, wait 15 minutes or have IAM issue a Temporary Access Pass.
- **Device shows non-compliant due to missing BitLocker/FileVault key** - Verify that the encryption status is reported in Intune; if missing, force a sync and re-issue the recovery key from Intune.
- **VPN fails with certificate error** - Confirm the machine certificate is present in the local store and not expired; re-enroll the device via Intune if needed.
- **Wi-Fi prompts for username/password** - This indicates the machine certificate is missing; re-push the ACME-Corp Wi-Fi profile through Intune.
- **MFA push not received** - Ensure the user has the latest Microsoft Authenticator version and that push notifications are not blocked by device battery-optimization settings.

When to escalate

Escalate to the Identity & Access Management (IAM) team when: the AD/Entra ID object cannot be found or created despite HR feed confirmation; license assignment fails after multiple attempts; the user requires a Temporary Access Pass because self-service password reset is unavailable; or there is a suspected mismatch between the employee's legal name and the account name that needs manual correction. When escalating, include the employee's full name, employee ID, start date, manager, ticket number, a screenshot of the Entra ID user blade (showing disabled status or missing license), and any relevant error messages (e.g., 'Account not found', 'License assignment failed').

Keywords: new joiner, onboarding, account setup, laptop provision, MFA enrollment, self service password reset, Entra ID, Active Directory, Microsoft 365 license, Intune compliance, Company Portal, GlobalProtect VPN, ACME-Corp Wi-Fi, temporary access pass, identity access management